



Decoding the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly Election

Content Briefing for Content Head

20 May, 2026

Agenda Overview

01

The geographic story

02

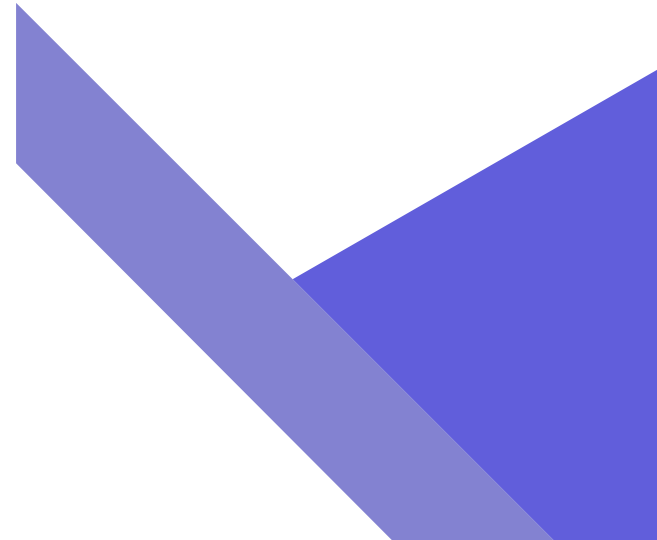
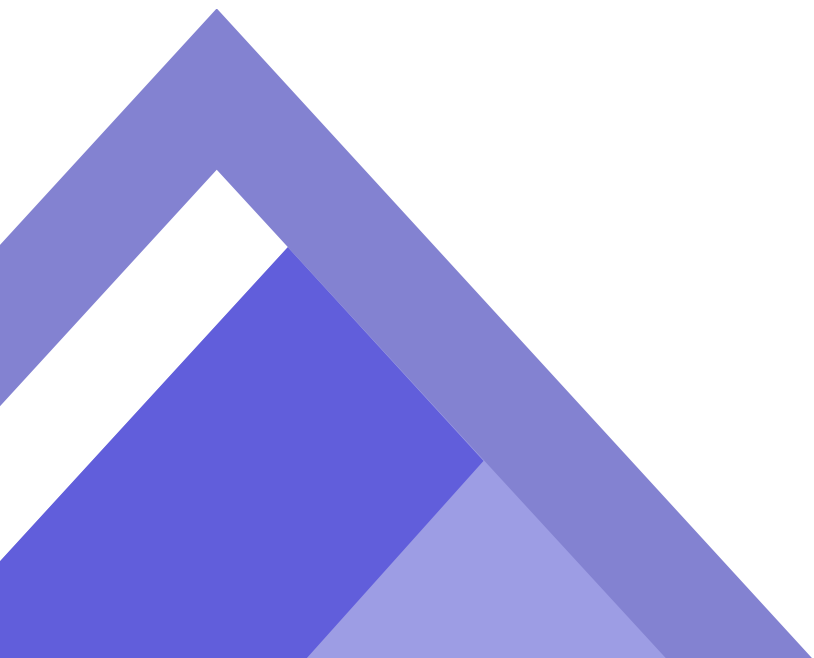
The flip story

03

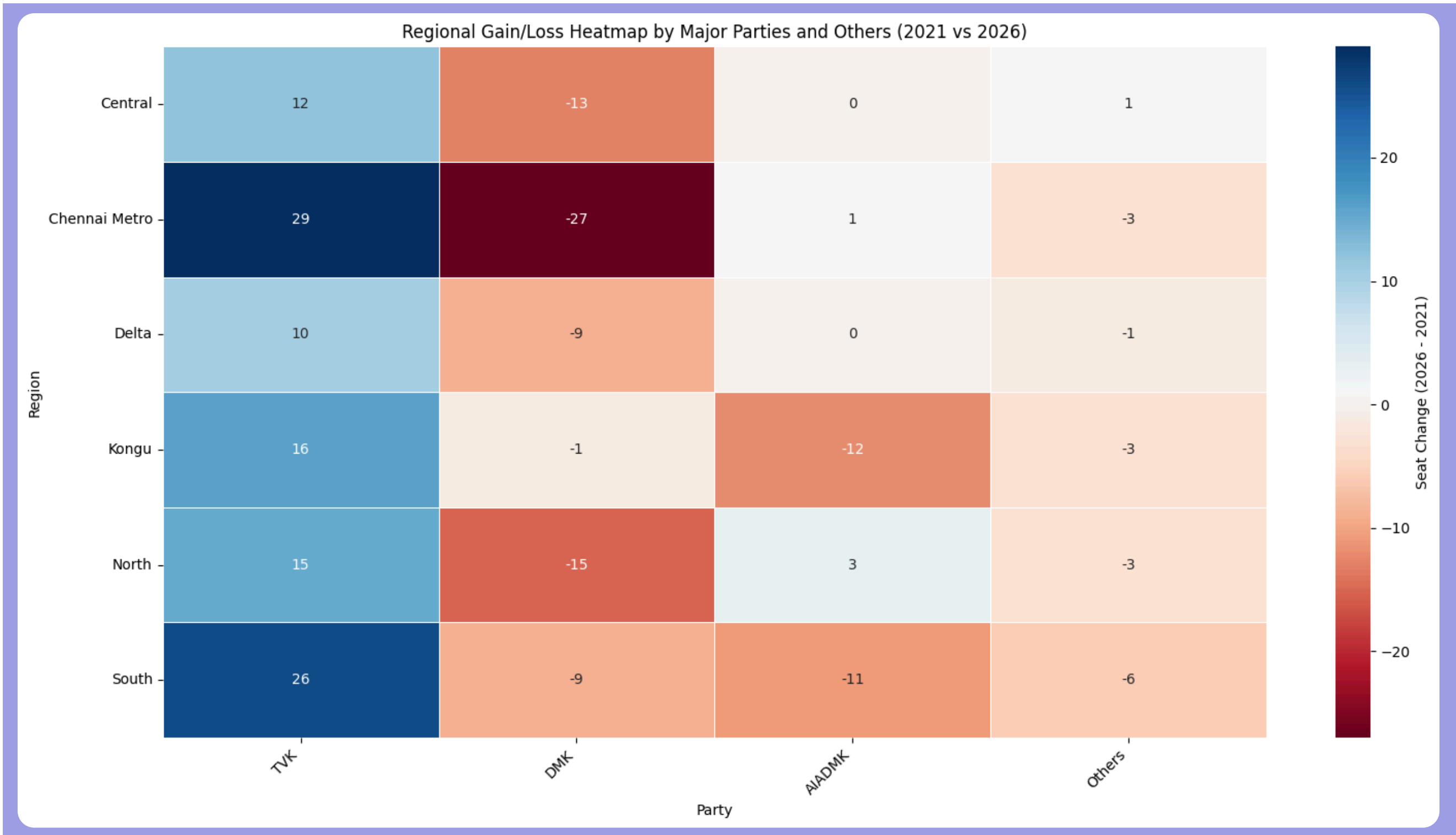
The vote share story

The geographic story

How did the seat distribution shift across Tamil Nadu's six regions (Chennai Metro, North, Central, Kongu, Delta, South) between 2021 and 2026? Where did each major formation gain or lose ground?



Regional Seat Distribution Shift



Total
Constituencies

234

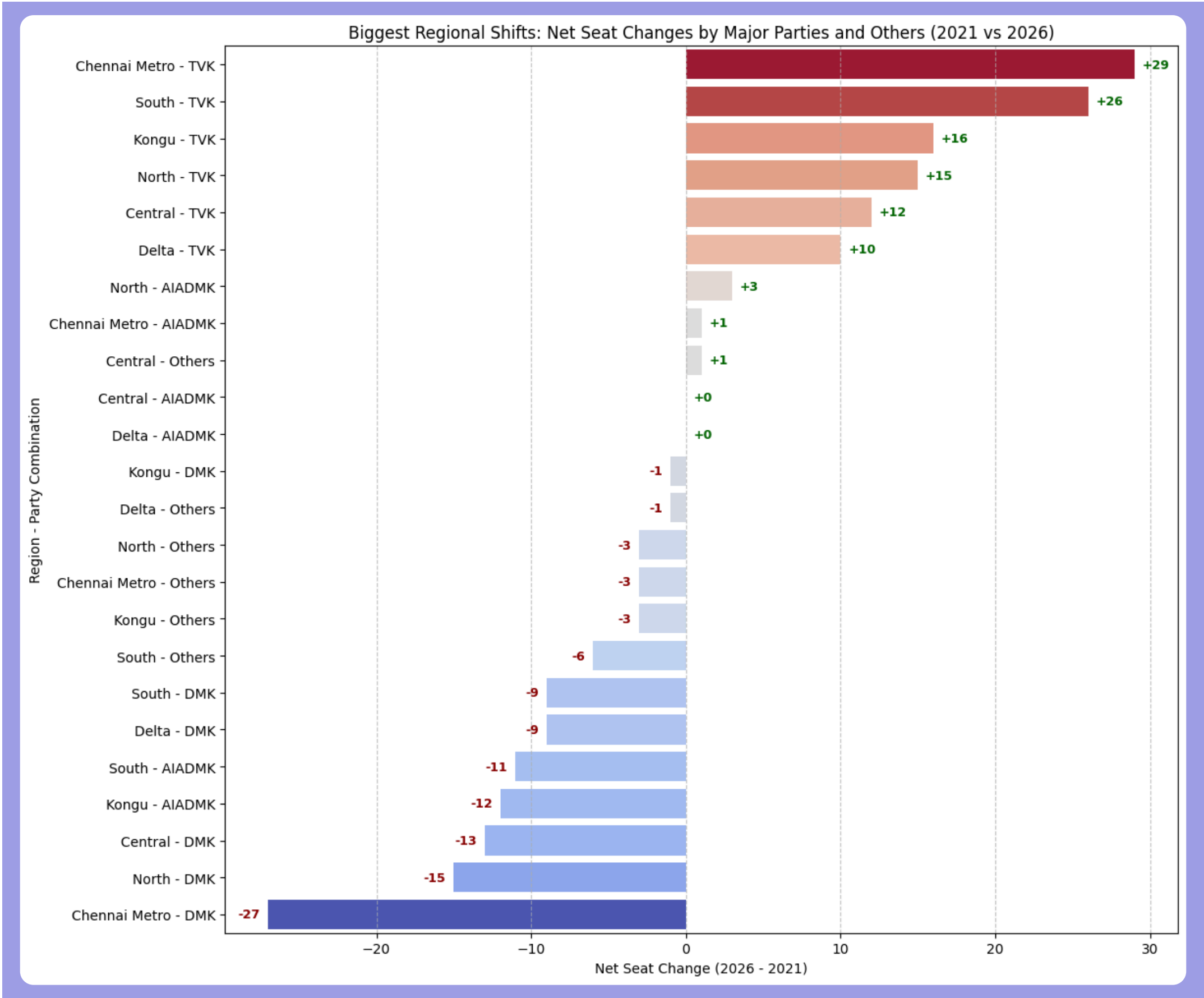
Regions
Analyzed

6

Tamil Nadu's 2026 seat redistribution was concentrated in specific regions rather than spread uniformly across the state.

- Chennai Metro recorded the sharpest regional redistribution between 2021 and 2026
- TVK recorded positive seat-change across all six editorial regions.
- Regional changes were uneven, with larger shifts concentrated in Chennai Metro, North, and South

Where Formations Gained or Lost Ground



**Sharpest
Expansion**

+29

TVK-Chennai Metro

**Sharpest
Contraction**

-27

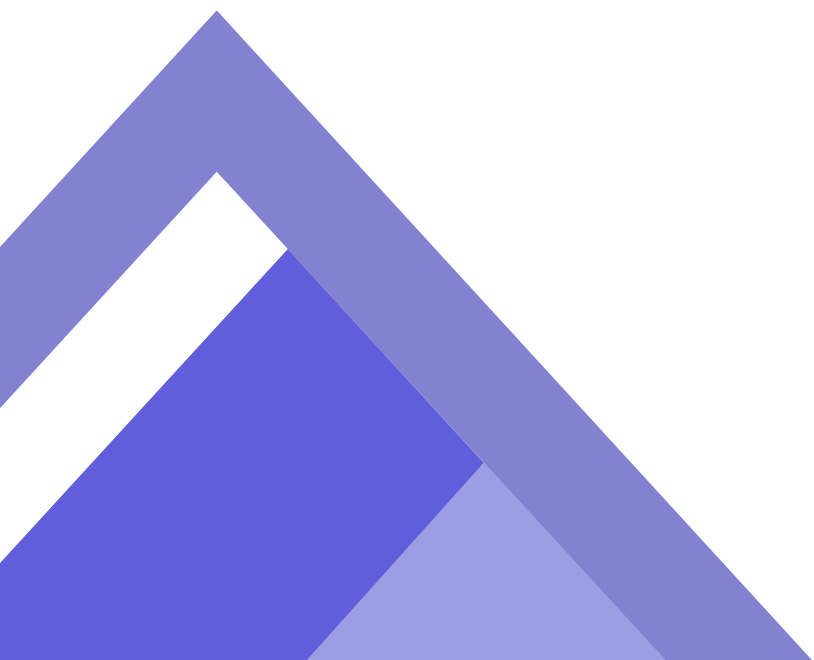
DMK-Chennai Metro

The largest gains and losses were concentrated in a few high-impact regional combinations.

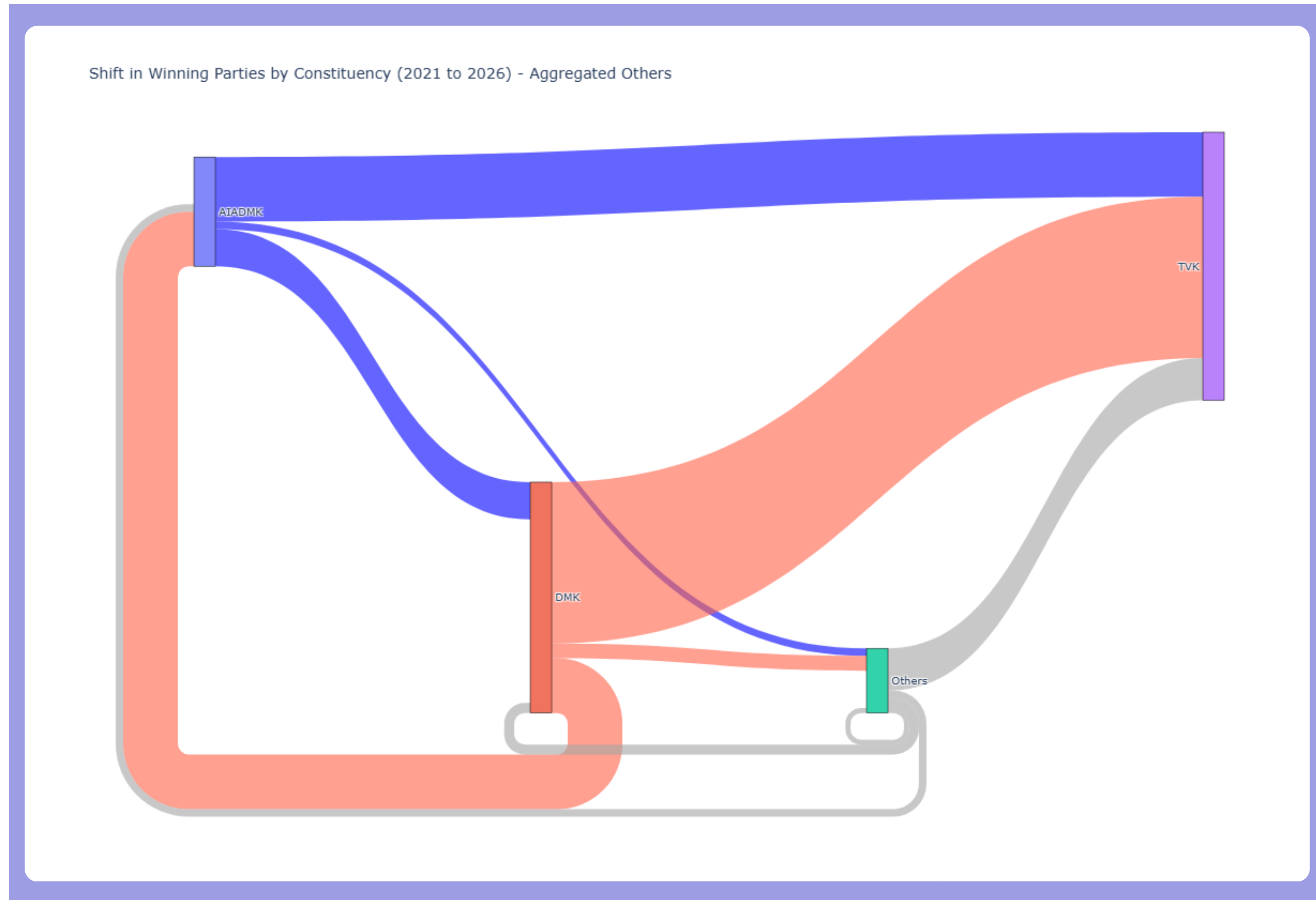
- TVK recorded the strongest regional expansion, particularly in Chennai Metro and South
- DMK experienced the largest regional contractions, especially in Chennai Metro and North
- AIADMK losses were concentrated primarily in Kongu and South regions

The flip story

In how many constituencies did the winning party change between 2021 and 2026? What pattern emerges?



Major Seat Realignments, 2021-26



**Total Flipped
Seats**

163

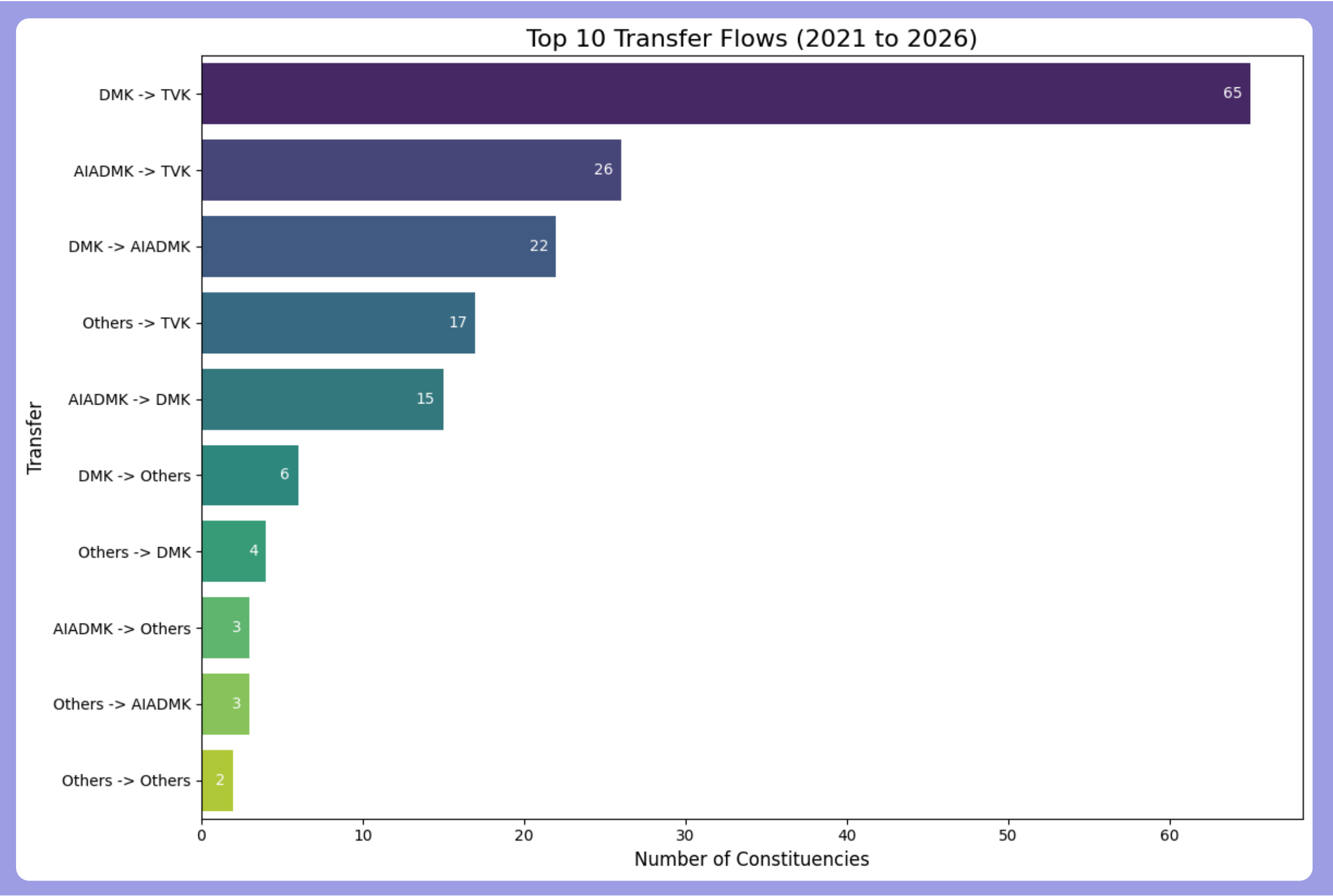
**Stable
Constituencies**

71

A large share of constituencies changed winning formations between 2021 and 2026

- Constituency-level transfers were concentrated among a few major formations
- TVK emerged as the largest recipient of flipped constituencies
- Despite wider redistribution, 71 constituencies retained their 2021 winning formation

Core Movement Patterns



**Largest Transfer
Flow**

65

DMK → TVK

**Most Stable
Formation**

40

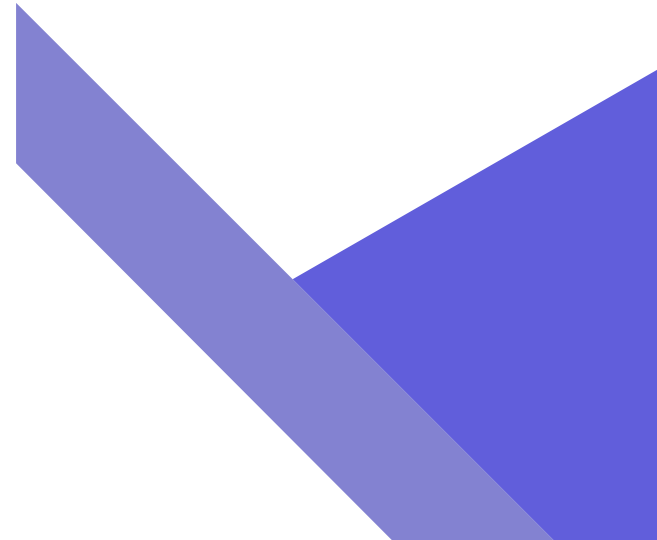
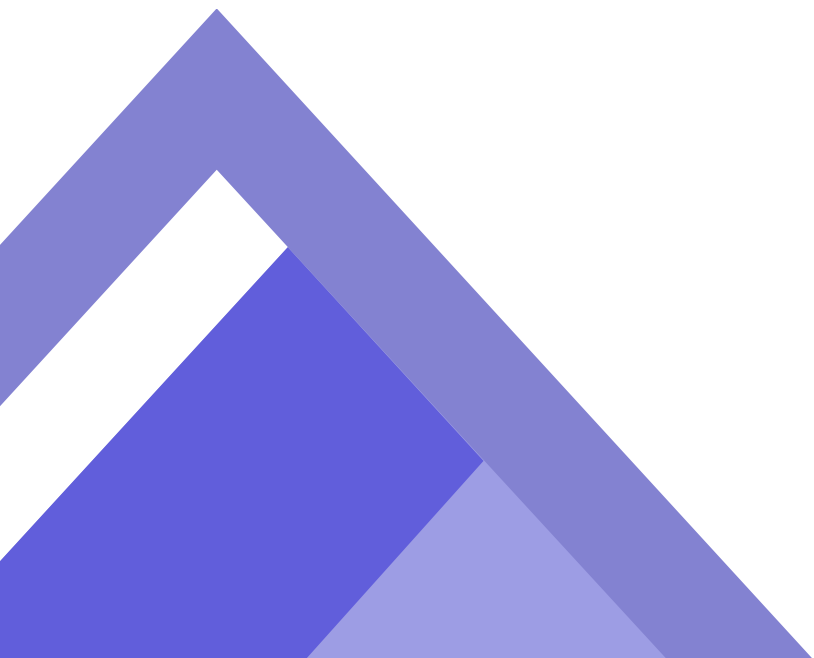
DMK

Constituency transfers were concentrated around a few high-volume political shifts.

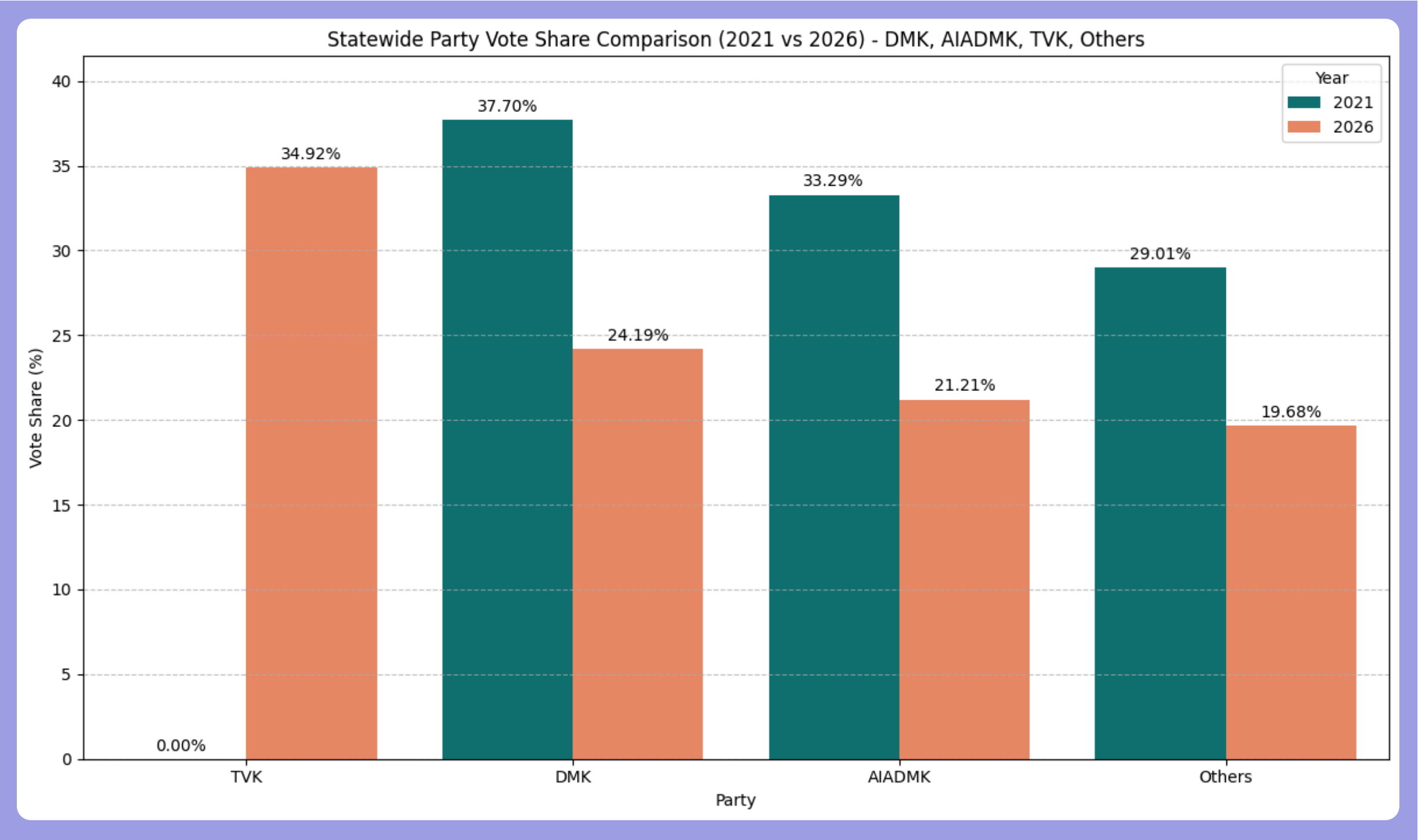
- The strongest constituency transfer flow was concentrated toward TVK
- Most high-volume flips originated from DMK and AIADMK-held constituencies
- Stability remained visible in several regional strongholds despite broader redistribution

The vote share story

Where did TVK's votes come from? Compare party vote share state-wide and by region in 2021 vs 2026. Did TVK pull from DMK, AIADMK, both, or from previously non-voting populations?



Statewide Vote Share Redistribution



Largest Vote
Share Gain

34.92%

TVK

Largest Vote
Share Decline

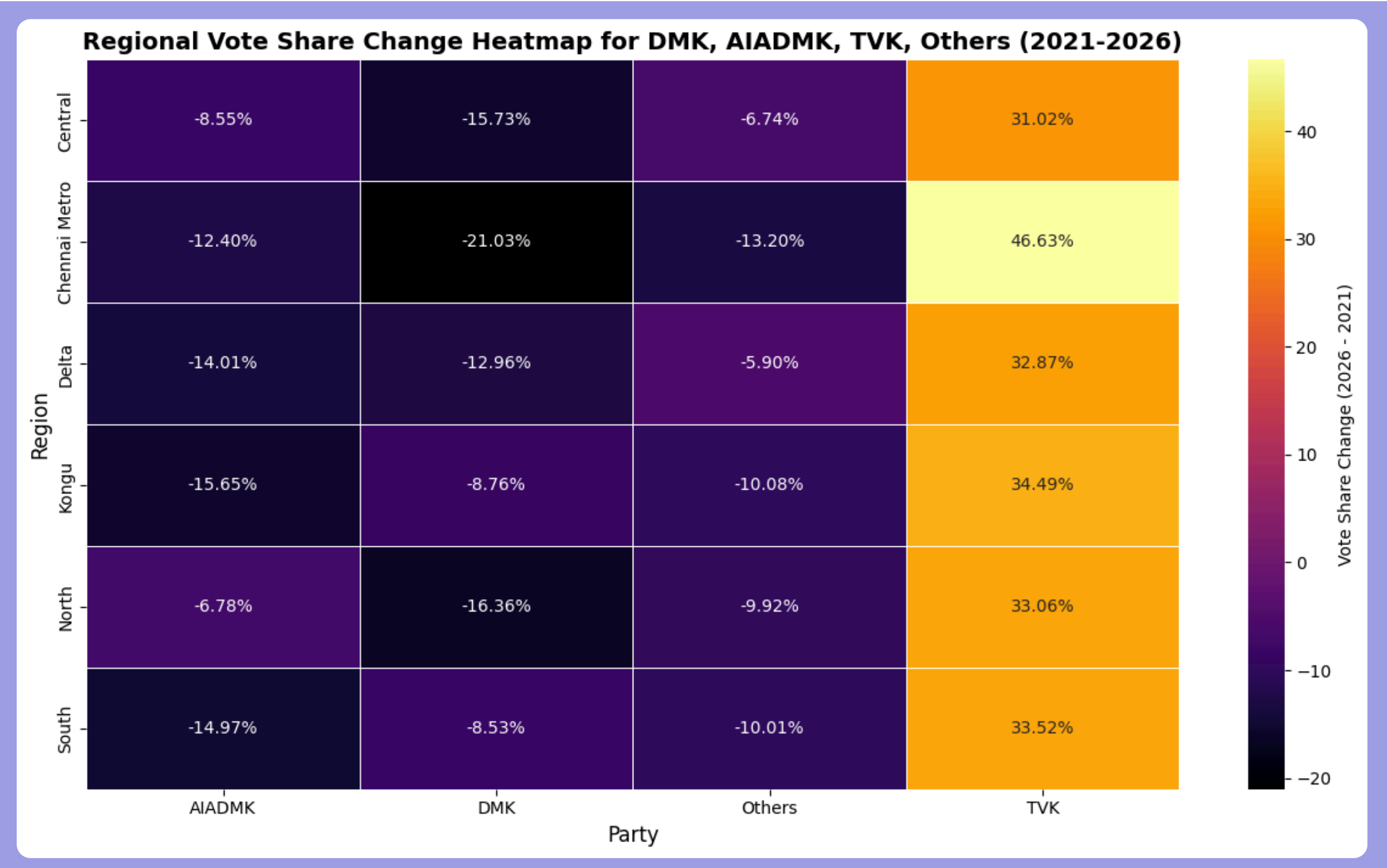
-13.51%

DMK

TVK’s statewide rise coincided with vote-share contractions across established formations.

- TVK recorded the largest statewide vote-share gain at +34.92 percentage points
- DMK showed the largest single-party decline at approximately -13.51 percentage points
- AIADMK also declined by approximately -12.08 percentage points, so the shift was not limited to one formation

Regional Vote Share Overlap



**Strongest TVK
Expansion**

46.63%

Chennai Metro

**Sharpest DMK
Contraction**

-21.03%

Chennai Metro)

Regional vote-share swings show TVK gains overlapping with declines across multiple formations.

- Chennai Metro and Kongu showed the strongest TVK expansion
- Regions with stronger TVK growth often coincided with sharper DMK contraction
- AIADMK declines were more regionally concentrated, particularly in Kongu, South, and Delta

Insights & Constraints

Final Insights

01

Regional redistribution in 2026 was concentrated rather than uniformly statewide.

02

Constituency-level transfers were highly directional, with TVK emerging as the largest recipient of flipped seats.

03

Vote-share redistribution overlapped with contractions across multiple established formations, particularly DMK and AIADMK.

Editorial Recommendations

- Regional swing analysis should be prioritized over statewide averages when interpreting electoral redistribution
- Constituency transfer flows provide deeper insight than seat totals alone
- Vote-share overlap patterns should be interpreted cautiously without voter-level behavioral data

Data Limitations

- Vote-share overlap does not establish direct voter migration between parties
- Absence of booth-level or survey-level data limits behavioral inference

The 2026 Tamil Nadu election reflected concentrated regional redistribution, directional constituency transfers, and broad vote-share realignment across major formations.



Thank You

20 May, 2026